



36 BCE

EARLIEST LONG COUNT DATE IN THE MAYAN CALENDAR

Mesoamerican peoples used the Long Count calendar system to record dates over long periods of time. Based on multiples of 20, it counted the time since a start-point in 3114 BCE, expressed in baktuns (roughly 394 years) and their subdivisions. The oldest Long Count inscription found was on a limestone stele of the Muxe-Zoque people at Chiapa de Corzo, Mexico, with a date of 7.15.3.2.13, or 8 December 36 BCE.

◁ A (late) Mayan calendrical stone

31 BCE

31 BCE

CLEOPATRA VII DEFEATED AT ACTIUM

Octavian, Lepidus, and Mark Antony, the victors in the civil war against Caesar's assassins, formed a Second Triumvirate in 43 BCE, but this dissolved and a new conflict began. Mark Antony allied with Egypt's Queen Cleopatra VII, but their fleet was destroyed at Actium off Greece's west coast, leaving Octavian master of the Roman world.



△ Battle of Actium, relief

50 BCE–100 CE ROMAN LITERATURE



Roman literature at first based itself on Greek models, but soon authors were writing epic poetry, drama, fiction, and non-fiction in Latin.

55–43 BCE The Roman statesman Cicero writes works on oratory and politics, including *De Oratore* (*On the Orator*).

42–19 BCE The poet Virgil (seated, above) writes the *Aeneid*, an epic poem telling of the flight to Italy of Aeneas, among other works.

c. 70–77 CE Pliny the Younger writes *The Natural History*, a compilation of all Roman scientific knowledge (15th-century page, above).

70–100 CE The lawyer Tacitus composes *Annals and Histories*, which is among the finest Latin historical writing.